

Eurobioc2026 BiocContainer Report

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Laurent Gatto ¹, **Dania Machlab** ², **Ata Badr Barzegar**³, **João F. Carrilho** ⁴, and **Michael B. Stadler** ⁵

1 Computational Biology and Bioinformatics, de Duve Institute, UCLouvain, Belgium **2** Dept of Biochemistry and Biophysics, National Bioinformatics Infrastructure Sweden, Science for Life Laboratory, Stockholm University, Box 1031, SE-17121 Solna, Sweden **3** Information Technology, Åbo Akademi University, Turku, Finland **4** Center for Mathematics and Applications (NOVA Math), NOVA School of Science and Technology (NOVA FCT), Caparica, Portugal **5** Friedrich Miescher Institute for Biomedical Research, Basel, Switzerland

Introduction

Containers enhance reproducibility and additionally offer a convenient way to share the setup used and needed to run a script. Offering a way to create containers which contain desired R packages from within R allows users to more easily create these containers and work with them. R packages like `dockerfiler` Fay et al. (2026) offer functions to create and work with Docker files within R. However, currently there is no convenient way to create Docker files and containers from R while also controlling for the bioconductor release. The aim in this hackathon was to create a minimal set of functions that offer this possibility, and this work eventually gave rise to the R package `SimpleBiocContainer`.

R package `SimpleBiocContainer`

As part of the European Bioconductor Hackathon 2026, we created an R package called `SimpleBiocContainer` which offers a more user friendly way to create, build and push Docker containers to [Dockerhub](#) from R. A working version of the package can be found on GitHub: <https://github.com/lgatto/SimpleBiocContainer.git>.

The functions in `SimpleBiocContainer` make use of the existing Bioconductor docker containers (see this [link](#) for more details), which already contain system dependencies and a few basic packages. On top of that, we add the user-specified Bioconductor/R packages using `BiocManager::install()`. The Bioconductor version, and thus the corresponding docker container, is automatically determined from the R session.

Currently, the package has two exported functions:

- `makeSimpleBiocContainer` creates a container directory and populates it with a Dockerfile and optional data and script directories.
- `buildPushDocker` builds and pushes the container to [Dockerhub](#) or optionally [Github container registry](#) directly from R.

Here is a simple example to illustrate its use:

```
library(SimpleBiocContainer)

container_path <- makeSimpleBiocContainer(
  package = "MsCoreUtils",
  container = "my_container",
  data = "data.rda",
  script = "script.R")
```



```
buildPushDocker(  
  container = container_path,  
  dockerUsername = "docker_username")
```

Conclusions / Future Work

The current version of the package covers all features that we wanted to include, but represents a simple first implementation that may require further refinement in the future.

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References

Fay, C., Guyader, V., Parry, J., & Rochette, S. (2026). *Dockerfiler: Easy dockerfile creation from r*. <https://doi.org/10.32614/CRAN.package.dockerfiler>

Author contributions